

Will Schupmann

Department of Sociology
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EDUCATION

Ph.D. Candidate in Sociology, University of California, Los Angeles (*expected completion Spring 2027*)

Field exams: Medical Sociology; Social Stratification, Inequality, and Mobility

Dissertation: Organ Donation Under Pressure: Metrics, Moralization, and Interorganizational Conflict

Committee: Stefan Timmermans (chair), Edward Walker, Gabriel Rossman, Jonathan Moreno

2022 M.A. in Sociology, University of California, Los Angeles

2017 B.A. in Health and Societies (minor in Biology), *summa cum laude*, University of Pennsylvania

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Medical sociology, organizations, inequality, moral markets, expertise, empirical bioethics, mixed methods

GRANTS, HONORS & AWARDS

2026-27 UCLA Meier Dissertation Fellowship (\$20,000)

2026 UCLA Sociology Sifton Undergraduate Research Mentorship Award
UCLA Sociology Service Award

2020-24 National Science Foundation Graduate Research Fellowship (\$145,000)

2024 UCLA Sociology Sifton Undergraduate Research Mentorship Award

2023 UCLA Graduate Summer Research Mentorship Program Grant (\$6,000)

UCLA Summer Institute in Computational Social Science

UCLA Sociology Sifton Undergraduate Research Mentorship Award

UCLA Sociology Excellence in Teaching Award

2022 UCLA Sociology Sifton Undergraduate Research Mentorship Award

UCLA Sociology Service Award

2017 Phi Beta Kappa

Penn College Alumni Society Prize in Health and Societies (\$500)

2016 Penn College Alumni Society Research Grant (\$1,000)

Penn International Internship Grant (\$4,000)

2015 Penn Undergraduate Research Mentoring Grant (\$2,500)

PUBLICATIONS (see [Google Scholar](#))

Journal articles

- 2025 Schupmann, Will, Julien Teitler, Nancy E. Reichman, and Kayuet Liu. 2025. "Physician networks and the rise of elective obstetric interventions." *Social Science & Medicine* 390:118854. doi:[10.1016/j.socscimed.2025.118854](#).
- Timmermans, Stefan, Will Schupmann, Rebecca Kaufman, and Aviad Raz. 2025. "Coping With the Spectre of Cardiac Mortality: The Role of Genetic Testing." *Sociology of Health & Illness* 47(8):e70107. doi:[10.1111/1467-9566.70107](#).
- 2024 Kaufman, Rebecca, Will Schupmann, Stefan Timmermans, and Aviad Raz. 2024. "High risk, mixed reward: Making genetic test results actionable in cardiology." *Social Science & Medicine* 354:117049. doi:[10.1016/j.socscimed.2024.117049](#).
- 2023 Schupmann, Will. 2023. "'We are not the ethics police': The professionalization of clinical ethicists and the regulation of medical decision-making." *Social Science & Medicine* 322:115808. doi:[10.1016/j.socscimed.2023.115808](#).
- Featured in *Medical Ethics Advisor* (2023).
- Wendler, David, Will Schupmann, and Xiaobai Li. 2023. "The ethics of 'net-risk' pediatric research: Views of IRB members and the US public." *International Journal of Pediatrics and Adolescent Medicine* 10(1):7–13. doi:[10.4103/ijpam.ijpam_2_23](#).
- Wendler, David, Will Schupmann, and Xiaobai Li. 2023. "Views of IRB members regarding phase 1 pediatric oncology trials." *Pediatric Hematology and Oncology* 40(1):14–25. doi:[10.1080/08880018.2022.2069894](#).
- 2022 Schupmann, Will, Xiaobai Li, and David Wendler. 2022. "Acceptable risks in pediatric research: Views of the U.S. public." *Pediatrics* 149(1):e2021052687. doi:[10.1542/peds.2021-052687](#).
- DiRago, Nicholas, Meiying Li, Thalia Tom, Will Schupmann, Yvonne Carrillo, Colleen M. Carey, and S. Michael Gaddis. 2022. "COVID-19 vaccine rollouts and the reproduction of urban spatial inequality: Disparities within large US cities in March and April 2021 by racial/ethnic and socioeconomic composition." *Journal of Urban Health* 99:191–207. doi:[10.1007/s11524-021-00589-0](#).
- 2021 Schupmann, Will, Skye A. Miner, Haley K. Sullivan, Jamie R. Glover, Janet E. Hall, Shepherd H. Schurman, and Benjamin E. Berkman. 2021. "Exploring the motivations of research participants who chose not to learn medically actionable secondary genetic findings about themselves." *Genetics in Medicine* 23:2281–2288. doi:[10.1038/s41436-021-01271-1](#).
- Featured in *Science Magazine* (2021).
- Schupmann, Will, Xiaobai Li, and David Wendler. 2021. "Do the potential medical benefits of phase 1 pediatric oncology trials justify the risks? Views of the United States public." *Journal of Pediatrics* 238:249–258.e3. doi:[10.1016/j.jpeds.2021.06.009](#).

- 2020 Schupmann, Will, and Jonathan D. Moreno. 2020. "Belmont in context." *Perspectives in Biology and Medicine* 63(2):220–239. doi:[10.1353/pbm.2020.0028](https://doi.org/10.1353/pbm.2020.0028).
- Schupmann, Will, Leila Jamal, and Benjamin E. Berkman. 2020. "Re-examining the ethics of genetic counselling in the genomic era." *Journal of Bioethical Inquiry* 17:325–335. doi:[10.1007/s11673-020-09983-w](https://doi.org/10.1007/s11673-020-09983-w).
- 2019 Jamal, Leila, Will Schupmann, and Benjamin E. Berkman. 2019. "An ethical framework for genetic counseling in the genomic era." *Journal of Genetic Counseling* 29(5):718–727. doi:[10.1002/jgc4.1207](https://doi.org/10.1002/jgc4.1207).
- 2018 Schupmann, Will. 2018. "Human experimentation in public schools: How schools served as sites of vaccine trials in the 20th century." *American Journal of Public Health* 108(8):1015–1022. doi:[10.2105/AJPH.2018.304423](https://doi.org/10.2105/AJPH.2018.304423).
- Featured in *EducationWeek* (2021), *History.com* (2025).
- Schupmann, Will, Katherine Riva, Seipone Mphele, Neo Moshashane, Mitchell Matesva, and Elizabeth Lowenthal. 2018. "Phenomenology of substance use among school-going adolescents in Botswana." *International Journal of School Health* 5(4):e82879. doi:[10.5812/intjsh.82879](https://doi.org/10.5812/intjsh.82879).
- Riva, Katherine, Lynne Allen-Taylor, Will Schupmann, Seipone Mphele, Neo Moshashane, and Elizabeth Lowenthal. 2018. "Prevalence and predictors of alcohol and drug use among secondary school students in Botswana: A cross-sectional study." *BMC Public Health* 18:1396. doi:[10.1186/s12889-018-6263-2](https://doi.org/10.1186/s12889-018-6263-2).
- Book chapters**
- 2023 Schupmann, Will, and Stefan Timmermans. 2023. "Sociology of the medical profession and para-professions." In *Handbook on the Sociology of Health and Medicine*, edited by Alan Petersen, pp. 199–212. Edward Elgar Publishing. doi:[10.4337/9781839104756.00022](https://doi.org/10.4337/9781839104756.00022).
- 2022 Schupmann, Will, and Christine Grady. 2022. "Highs and Lows of Research: Exploring Value in Research Cases." In *Oxford Handbook of Research Ethics*, edited by Douglas Mackay and Ana Iltis, pp. 42–66. Oxford University Press. doi:[10.1093/oxfordhb/9780190947750.013.3](https://doi.org/10.1093/oxfordhb/9780190947750.013.3).

Works in progress

Schupmann, Will. "Metric reactivity under inter-organizational dependence: The case of organ donation."

Schupmann, Will. "When donation becomes possible: Temporal authority and inter-organizational coordination at the end of life."

Lucas-Griffin, Sawyer, Brittany Acors, Skye A. Miner, Will Schupmann, Benjamin E. Berkman. "'What Is It About Opting Out?': Why People Choose Not to Learn About Their Genetic Health Risks." Conditionally accepted at *Journal of Law, Medicine, and Ethics*

PUBLIC WRITING

- 2021 Schupmann, Will. [“Why Kids Should Get Their COVID-19 Vaccines at School.”](#) *Slate*, March 16, 2021.
- 2017 Schupmann, Will. [“Strange Brotherhood: The hidden chapter of wartime human experimentation in the DKE house.”](#) *The Pennsylvania Gazette*, September 2017.
- Schupmann, Will, and Jonathan Moreno. [“Will Measles Parties Return?”](#) *Huffington Post*, January 30, 2017.

PRESENTATIONS

- 2026 “The Fragility of Optimization: Performance Metrics in Organ Donation.” American Sociological Association, Medical Sociology Roundtable Session.
- 2024 “Building Trust in Organ Donation: How Organ Procurement Organizations Navigate Barriers to Consent.” American Sociological Association, Medical Sociology Regular Session.
- “Cultivating Public Approval of Organ Donation.” American Sociological Association, Medical Sociology Roundtable Session (Declined).
- 2023 “‘We are not the ethics police’: The professionalization of clinical ethicists and the regulation of medical decision-making.” Language and Bioethics Collaboratory, Stanford University.
- 2022 “‘We are not the ethics police’: The professionalization of clinical ethicists and the regulation of medical decision-making.” American Sociological Association, Medical Sociology Roundtable Session.
- “‘We are not the ethics police’: The professionalization of clinical ethicists and the regulation of medical decision-making.” American Society of Bioethics and Humanities, Paper Presentation.
- 2020 “Exploring the Motivations of Research Participants Who Chose Not to Learn Medically Actionable Genetic Information about Themselves.” ELSI Congress, Columbia University (Cancelled due to COVID-19).
- 2019 “Re-examining Nondirectiveness in the Genomic Era.” American Society for Bioethics and Humanities, Paper Presentation.

TEACHING

- 2026 Teaching Assistant, *Development of Sociological Theory*
Reader, *Social Data Science*
- 2025 Reader, *Social Psychology*
- 2023 Teaching Assistant, *Death, Dying, and Afterlife*
Teaching Assistant, *Negotiating Medical Care*
- 2022 Teaching Assistant, *Sociology of Crime*

SERVICE

- 2025- Ad hoc reviewer, *Sociology of Health & Illness, Social Science & Medicine - Qualitative Research in Health*
- 2021- Co-organizer, UCLA Health Working Group
- 2021- Mentor, UCLA Sociology Honors Thesis Mentoring Program
- 2020 Co-organizer, Mid-Atlantic Bioethics Fellows Conference

PREVIOUS EMPLOYMENT (SELECTED)

- 2019-20 **National Institutes of Health**, Department of Bioethics, Pre-doctoral Fellow
Conducted bioethics-related normative and empirical research; attended courses; participated in NIH Bioethics Consult Service; shadowed clinical rounds and IRB meetings.
- 2017-18 **Urban Institute**, Research to Action Lab, Research Assistant
Conducted research on social impact investing, evidence-based policymaking, administrative data challenges, community health centers, and “smart cities” in developing countries. Wrote and contributed to policy briefs, literature reviews, blogs, and long-form research reports.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Software: R, Python, NVivo, Qualtrics, Mechanical Turk

REFERENCES

Stefan Timmermans
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